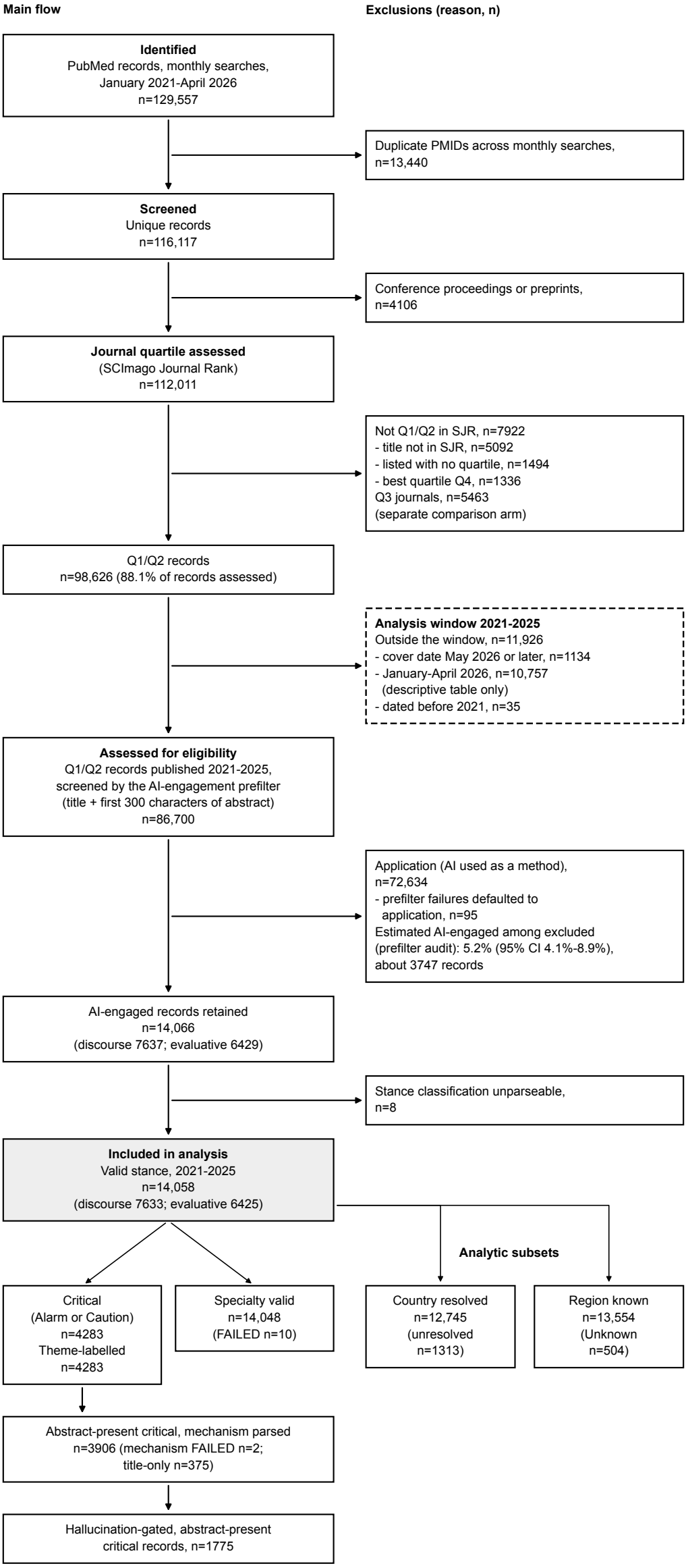
Main flow
Exclusions (reason, n)
Identified
PubMed records, monthly searches,
January 2021-April 2026
n=129,557
Duplicate PMIDs across monthly searches,
n=13,440
Screened
Unique records
n=116,117
Conference proceedings or preprints,
n=4106
Journal quartile assessed
(SCImago Journal Rank)
n=112,011
Not Q1/Q2 in SJR, n=7922
- title not in SJR, n=5092
- listed with no quartile, n=1494
- best quartile Q4, n=1336
Q3 journals, n=5463
(separate comparison arm)
Q1/Q2 records
n=98,626 (88.1% of records assessed)
Analysis window 2021-2025
Outside the window, n=11,926
- cover date May 2026 or later, n=1134
- January-April 2026, n=10,757
(descriptive table only)
- dated before 2021, n=35
Assessed for eligibility
Q1/Q2 records published 2021-2025,
screened by the AI-engagement prefilter
(title + first 300 characters of abstract)
n=86,700
Application (AI used as a method),
n=72,634
- prefilter failures defaulted to
application, n=95
Estimated AI-engaged among excluded
(prefilter audit): 5.2% (95% CI 4.1%-8.9%),
about 3747 records
AI-engaged records retained
n=14,066
(discourse 7637; evaluative 6429)
Stance classification unparseable,
n=8
Included in analysis
Valid stance, 2021-2025
n=14,058
(discourse 7633; evaluative 6425)
Analytic subsets
Critical
(Alarm or Caution)
n=4283
Theme-labelled
n=4283
Specialty valid
n=14,048
(FAILED n=10)
Country resolved
n=12,745
(unresolved
n=1313)
Region known
n=13,554
(Unknown
n=504)
Abstract-present critical, mechanism parsed
n=3906 (mechanism FAILED n=2;
title-only n=375)
Hallucination-gated, abstract-present
critical records, n=1775